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Mayor again calls for taxes on large corporations

Johnson tight-lipped on specific plans as budget showdown looms

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

With his city budget pitch for next year looming, Mayor Brandon Johnson on Tuesday again argued large corporations must pay more taxes to help Chicago balance its books.

Johnson remained tight-lipped on his specific budget plans during a City Hall news conference, but hinted he may also propose higher taxes on cloud computing software and social media companies.

He called on aldermen and state legislators to clear the way for his renewed tax-the-rich push — a sign he is once again willing to wage a high-stakes public fight as City Hall crafts a spending package. Johnson is expected to unveil his budget proposal on Oct. 21, starting the clock for him and City Council opponents to pass something before the calendar flips to 2027, when all their seats are on the election ballot.

The mayor returned to a familiar refrain as he said there is a clear choice ahead: Ask Chicago families to do more with less, or challenge corporations benefiting from federal tax cuts to pay "their fair share."

"What remains to be seen is whether the corporate-aligned caucus will have the collective courage to choose the interests and priorities of Chicagoans, or choose to cower before the influence and campaign donations of corporations," he said, a reference to the bruising battle that ended in December with aldermen passing a 2026 spending plan against Johnson's wishes and without his proposed corporate head tax.

Johnson and aldermen face an $882 million budget gap for 2027, the mayor told reporters in early September.

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Pope Leo XIV arrives at the Agostino Gemelli Polyclinic in Rome on Tuesday, where he was operated on to remove a lung nodule.
ALESSANDRA TARANTINO/AP

Pope Leo diagnosed with lung cancer, Vatican says

Surgery to remove lower lobe on his right side 'successful and there were no complications'

By Nicole Winfield and Colleen Barry
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ROME — Pope Leo XIV underwent surgery Tuesday that confirmed that he has lung cancer, and doctors removed the lower lobe of his right lung, the Vatican said.

Tests confirmed a diagnosis of lung adenocarcinoma, the Vatican said in a medical bulletin after the surgery. It said the diagnosis had been suspected by preoperative tests and was confirmed during surgery.

The statement made no mention of treatment going forward, and the Vatican said doctors were not currently speaking of chemotherapy or other therapies pending the results of other tests. The Vatican press office noted the medical statement spoke of the "radical" removal of the lobe as an indication that doctors removed all suspect tissue in hopes of removing any lingering traces of the cancer.

Leo's lymph nodes also would have been removed and tested, to determine if the cancer had spread, and there was no word yet on those test results.

"Adenocarcinoma is the most common (type of lung cancer), also with the most favorable prognosis," said Dr. Stephen Liu, a lung cancer expert at Georgetown's Lombardi Comprehensive Cancer Center. "While we know the diagnosis we now need to know the stage.

"We now need to know how big it is, how many spots in the lung are involved. Is it just one nodule, or more than one, and the lymph nodes, are they cancerous?" Liu said.

If the cancer has spread, more tests will be needed to determine what kind of therapy to pursue, he said. Options include chemotherapy, a combination of chemotherapy and immunotherapy or targeted therapy, which involves oral pills for specific cancers.

The 71-year-old was in the operating room for about three hours, the statement said. The surgery itself lasted about 90 minutes.

"The surgery was successful, and there were no complications," the statement said.

Leo had walked into Rome's

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Brian Gumino, engineering manager at Richardson Electronics, opens the casing on a AMOGREENTECH battery used for electric locomotives on Monday in La Fox. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Taking a big step in battery storage

Expansion of operation helps state's clean energy goals, but more is needed

By John Lippert
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

To keep up with artificial intelligence, Illinois needs batteries big enough to keep its air conditioners running on hot summer nights and to replenish its electrical grid during winter storms lasting for days.

The state took a step in this direction Monday when Richardson Electronics said it would expand production of commercial-scale storage batteries at its factory in La Fox, a suburb west of Chicago.

Richardson, a diversified manufacturer of power products, expects to sell batteries worldwide. But company officials say they'll deploy many of their batteries in Illinois because of the state's hefty tax incentives for renewable power and for batteries that make solar and wind less intermittent.

When layered on top of each other, Illinois and federal tax incentives add up to almost the entire cost of one of Richardson's storage batteries, said Scott DuBois, director of the company's storage operations.

The battery, which the company plans to build at its La Fox site next summer, would be able to store 5 megawatts of power and will cost about $3 million. It will be the largest battery ever connected to the grid by an Illinois company, Richardson officials said.

Without more batteries, Illinois will be even more reliant on

See **BATTERY** on Page A4

ELECTION 2026 9TH CONGRESSIONAL DISTRICT

Biss aims to keep Dems' hold on deep-blue area vs. Elleson

Evanston's mayor running against pastor who has raised $0

By Olivia Olander
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Voters in Illinois' deep-blue 9th Congressional District may feel they already chose their next member of Congress in March's open Democratic primary. Democrats have held the North Side and north suburban seat since 1949, and except for a brief stretch, only two people have represented it in that time.

Still, Democratic nominee Daniel Biss, Evanston's mayor, is continuing to define what kind of Democrat he'll be in Washington. And Republican nominee John Elleson, a suburban pastor, keeps campaigning even though he isn't raising any money.

Endorsed by retiring U.S. Rep. Jan Schakowsky, Biss won a dramatic 15-way primary by walking a tightrope between his party's centrist and insurgent progressive wings. His closest rivals were moderate Democratic state Sen. Laura Fine and unconventional progressive political commentator Kat Abughazaleh.

Now, after party-dividing primary contests in nearby swing states like Wisconsin and Michigan, the second-term mayor is no more eager to be boxed in than he was during the primary.

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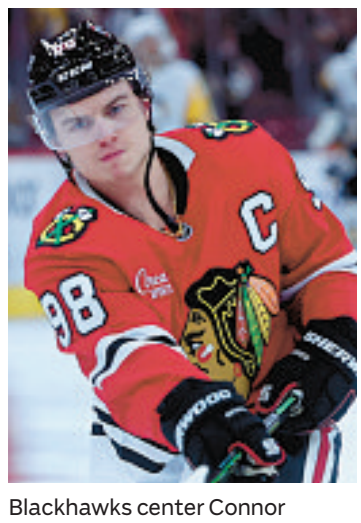
INSIDE

Bedard 'pumped' to be back in lineup

Blackhawks center and captain Connor Bedard joined the lineup on Tuesday, returning weeks ahead of schedule from left shoulder surgery. **Sports**

Highly anticipated Hooligan opens

A "neo-Midwestern bistro" from Christian Hunter, a Michelin-award winning chef, opens in Logan Square. **Food & Health**



Blackhawks center Connor Bedard warms up on Tuesday.
CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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